SHIELD-AI

Buyer's Journey Bridge

How the two SHIELD-AI slide decks work together

The Two-Deck Strategy

Deck 1: Business Decision Makers

Audience: CISO, CRO, COO, CIO, GC, Board

Goal: Secure budget and executive sponsorship

Tone: Urgency, regulatory risk, ROI, competitive necessity

Key slides: Why Now (gut punch), 2×2 quadrant positioning, business case table, service tiers with pricing

Duration: 20 minutes + Q&A

Deck 2: Technical SME Deep Dive

Audience: AI engineers, security architects, AI leads, platform engineers, compliance specialists

Goal: Drive technical implementation decisions

Tone: Depth, architecture, decision trees, implementable controls

Key slides: Reference architecture (slide 3), alternatives comparison, per-pillar decision trees, deployment topology guidance

Duration: 45-60 minutes (can be split across sessions)

The Buyer's Journey

1

Awareness

Trigger event: incident, regulator inquiry, peer breach

2

Executive Buy-In

Deck 1 presented to CISO/ Board — budget approved

3

First Engagement

SHIELD-AI Lite — 2-3 week assessment, low commitment

4

Technical Kickoff

Deck 2 with SME team — architecture, controls, implementation

5

Delivery & Assurance

Standard/Enterprise engagement — 12-16 weeks to L3

Key insight: The gap between Step 2 (budget) and Step 4 (technical kickoff) is where SHIELD-AI Lite lives. It converts executive intent into technical reality without requiring a full commitment.

Suggested Engagement Flow

Week 1

Executive meeting

Deck 1 to CISO + decision-makers

30 minutes → decision to proceed

Weeks 2-4

Lite engagement

Assessment + report + board briefing

$25-45K investment

Week 5

Technical kickoff

Deck 2 to SMEs

Architecture + control planning

Weeks 6-20

Standard delivery

Implementation to L3 maturity

$120-250K investment

Ongoing

Assurance

Quarterly reviews + continuous monitoring

$50-800K/yr

How to Present Each Deck

Presenting Deck 1 (Business)

- Start with the "Why Now" story — the gut punch, not the framework
- Use the 2×2 quadrant to show positioning in 5 seconds
- Let the business case table speak for itself — stop and let them read
- Mention blind peer references: "major bank", "government agency"
- Leave the board briefing slide as a leave-behind (don't present it)
- **After the meeting:** Hand them Deck 2 and say "here's how your team will evaluate this."

Presenting Deck 2 (Technical)

- Start at the reference architecture (slide 3) — this is the anchor
- Skip slides that aren't relevant to the audience (e.g., skip MCP if they don't use it)
- Use the alternatives comparison slide to handle "we already use NIST+OWASP" objection
- For each pillar, present the decision tree first, then the controls
- If audience is time-pressed: pillars 1-2-5 (MS, IAM, MIR) cover the highest-impact controls
- End with the "Try It Today" slide to drive action

Objection Handling Cheat Sheet

Objection	Who Says It	Response	Which Deck
"We already have ISM compliance"	CISO	ISM has no AI-specific controls. SHIELD-AI maps every control to ISM IDs — you're compliant, but not covered.	Both
"We use NIST AI RMF + OWASP"	Security Architect	Three separate frameworks vs one integrated one. SHIELD-AI gives AU regulatory mapping and maturity progression neither provides.	Deck 2, Slide 7
"Too expensive"	CFO / COO	$25K Lite. If Lite finds nothing, you spent $25K to confirm your posture. If it finds issues, $25K was the cheapest insurance you'll buy.	Deck 1, Slides 8-9
"We'll build it ourselves"	Engineering Lead	12-18 months and $600K-$1.2M to build what we deliver in 4-16 weeks at $120-250K. Plus: expertise you can't hire.	Deck 2, Slide 22
"AI security isn't a priority yet"	CRO / Board	Your competitors are deploying agentic AI now. The question is not "if" you have an AI incident — it's "when" and "how prepared are you?"	Deck 1, Slides 1-3
"We need to see it first"	Technical Lead	Reference implementation at shield-ai/reference (GitHub). Assessment toolkit: one command to inventory your estate. Try before you buy.	Deck 2, Slide 25

Ready to present

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Security Architecture Practice

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